

January

1

45 BCE

Julian calendar

In ancient Rome, a new calendar named after ruler Julius Caesar came into use. In this calendar, the length of a year became the number of days we know it today – 365, increasing to 366 every fourth year.



Born this day

1894 Satyendra Nath Bose, mathematician and physicist from British-occupied India. German-born US physicist Albert Einstein was a friend of Bose, and built on Bose's theories in some of his own work.

1959

Cuban Revolution

Nearly six years of civil war between the Cuban government and communist rebels came to an end. Revolutionary leader Fidel Castro overthrew president Fulgencio Batista, who fled to the Dominican Republic at dawn. Castro seized power and remained in charge of Cuba for 49 years until 2008.



Also on this day

1801 Italian astronomer Giuseppe Piazzi spotted the dwarf planet Ceres – the biggest object ever discovered in the asteroid belt.

1863 US president Abraham Lincoln issued the Emancipation Proclamation during the US Civil War, freeing millions of enslaved people.

1892 Ellis Island Immigration Station in New York Harbor, USA, started processing European immigrants. The first was Irish teenager Annie Moore.

2002 The Euro

With the new Euro currency entering circulation, 12 countries in the European Union (EU) replaced their national currencies with Euro banknotes and coins.

